ROBERT ABBY

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SUMMARY

I'm a frontend engineer with 15 years of experience building products. I've led frontend engineering at PartySlate, worked with users on design and usability at SAVO, and now build and run WavePoint. Over time, my work has grown beyond the code. I enjoy figuring out what a product needs, working through it with the team, staying involved through design and development, and across disciplines to make ideas real. Mentoring other engineers has also been an important part of my work.

EXPERIENCE

Founder & Operator

WavePoint **November 2025 - Present, Bellingham, WA**

- Lead product direction, design, engineering, and day-to-day operations for WavePoint, an iPhone astrology and reflection app, in collaboration with my wife, Shayna.
- Built the native iOS app with SwiftUI, bringing together charts, readings, and personal records, and brought it into internal and external TestFlight.
- Designed the Free and Premium experience, including upgrade, purchase, and restoration flows.
- Built and maintain the supporting website and product demonstrations using Next.js, React, and TypeScript.
- Use AI-assisted tools throughout research, design, development, and review, while staying hands-on with product decisions and implementation.

Technology Strategist & IT Manager

VIMSIA **March 2025 - November 2025, St. Thomas, USVI**

- Led technology strategy for a PK-12 school, partnering with administration on AI integration in educational settings.
- Owned infrastructure, procurement, and support operations; reduced support requests 20% through training and systems improvements.

Staff Engineer

PartySlate **December 2018 - February 2024, Chicago, IL**

- Senior-most frontend engineer through PartySlate's growth from a 12-person startup to a 50+ employee Series-B company, leading architecture for a React/GraphQL frontend on a Ruby on Rails backend.
- Led the rewrite of the Find Venues page - the highest-traffic page on the platform - into an interactive map view with redesigned search, driving a 150% increase in venue inquiries.
- Raised site-wide Lighthouse accessibility from 78 to 95 and performance to 90+ through lazy loading, code splitting, and WCAG 2.1 AA compliance — cutting initial bundle size 40% and average page load by 2.3 seconds on high-traffic marketplace pages.
- Built and maintained a shared UI component library (25+ modules, React, TypeScript, Chakra UI, Storybook), cutting feature rollout cycles by 40% across teams.
- Shipped 10+ large-scale features end-to-end, from requirements and cross-functional definition through agile delivery.
- Served as Technical Lead across multiple initiatives: architectural guidance, code review standards, mentoring through 1-on-1s, and org-wide React/GraphQL standards enforced via ESLint/Prettier in CI.

Senior UX Engineer

project44 **June 2018 - December 2018, Chicago, IL**

- Built map-based logistics interfaces (HERE Maps API) in a React/Redux codebase on the Product Experience team; established a living style guide and UI component library with Ant Design and Rollup.js.

Senior UI/UX & Product Developer

SAVO **April 2013 - June 2018, Chicago, IL**

- Led the spinout of an autonomous UI/UX team; conducted 50+ user research sessions and usability interviews, contributing to a holistic design language and living design system.
- Founded the SAVO Front-End Guild, a recurring org-wide forum on frontend best practices.

Web Developer

Web2Carz **November 2011 - March 2013, Highland Park, IL**

- Built consumer-facing galleries, forms, and a standalone mobile web app; introduced git and a formal deployment process.

EDUCATION

Business Administration Studies

American InterContinental University

CERTIFICATIONS

Designing & Building AI Products & Services
MIT xPRO • 2024

Certified Scrum Product Owner
Scrum Alliance • 2017

SKILLS

Frontend: React, Next.js (App Router, RSC), TypeScript, JavaScript (ES6+), TanStack Query, Apollo Client, GraphQL, REST, Zustand, Zod, CSS, Tailwind CSS, Chakra UI, Framer Motion, Vite, Webpack, accessibility (WCAG/a11y), performance optimization

Testing: Jest, React Testing Library, Cypress

AI & Tooling: Claude Code, Codex, DeepSeek Harness, MCP, agentic workflows, prompt engineering, n8n, LM Studio

Platform: Node.js, Ruby on Rails, AWS (S3, ECS, CloudWatch, Route 53), Docker, Vercel, CI/CD, Git/GitHub, Figma